

Opinion Ideas – The Daily Gamecock

University of South Carolina: Campus Life & Facilities

• Parking & Transportation

- General parking issues on campus
- Blossom Street Garage problems
- Lack of left-turn arrows in Columbia
- Safety concerns between scooters and pedestrians
- Why USC doesn't offer free service on The COMET bus system when Midlands Tech does.
 - * *Angle:* This policy seems to work against the interests of students with less financial means.
- Differences in driving culture: North vs. South

• Campus Infrastructure & Services

- Poor Wi-Fi quality on campus
- Leaky ceilings in the women's squad facilities
- Critiques and suggestions for campus food and local restaurants
- Accessibility and awareness of the campus food pantry
- Vending machines on campus need to be more reliable, offer better options, and have an easier way to report when they are broken.
- Can the live people-tracking system used in the library and Russell House be implemented at the Strom and Blatt fitness centers?

• Housing & Development

- Deteriorating conditions of apartments and dorms
- The high cost of accessible apartments
- The university's plan to buy land for Greek Village expansion
 - * *Angle:* How this expansion, combined with the Williams-Brice expansion, reduces available field areas for sports clubs.

• Campus Safety & Security

- General crime on and around campus
- The role and perception of campus police
- Whether students feel safe living off-campus
- Safety concerns at the frat lots, including:
 - * Reports of girls going missing
 - * Distance from the main campus
 - * Aggressive interactions between students and security

- * The presence of the "man behind the frat lots"

- **Athletics & Game Day**

- Opinion on the Williams-Brice Stadium expansion
 - * *Angle:* How are sports clubs losing more field areas due to this expansion?
- The reasoning behind frequent noon football games
- The amount of trash left on bleachers after games (and that ROTC cadets clean it up)
- The culture of chanting "Fire Beamer"
- Policies regarding alcohol in the stadium
- The significance of Dawn Staley's contract and what it says about how USC values women's sports

University of South Carolina: Academics & Policy

- **University Initiatives & Technology**

- The number of EVs is increasing, but infrastructure is lacking.
 - * *Angle:* How is USC failing to address this? Tie this into the new battery facility, the nuclear partnership, the increasing number of students buying EVs, and the "OBBS" initiative.
- The new battery facility is being built on the site of a failed green energy project from 2006.
 - * *Angle:* Are we repeating the mistakes of the past?
- USC's nuclear partnership and why don't we have nuclear reactors on campus?
 - * *Angle:* A theoretical argument about the benefits, acknowledging the technical challenges involved.

- **University Communication & Response**

- Critique of USC's poor communication with students regarding safety
- Should the university have canceled classes for the hurricane?
 - * A statement should be released about students and families being impacted by the storm (e.g., laptops destroyed, power outages in hometowns like Greenville and in Florida).

- **Academics & Registration**

- The university's decision to stop paying for the schedule planner feature, making class registration more difficult for students.
- The gap between high school and college education in South Carolina, noting how different schools had better resources.
- How alumni feel about their UofSC education and its value in the job market.

- **Admissions & Tuition**

- Debate over in-state vs. out-of-state tuition policies.
- Opinion on the policy that automatically accepts the top 10% of South Carolina high school students.
- The impact of the new digitized SAT on incoming students.

- **History & Community**

- An editorial on how the university handles its own history and state history.
- Appreciating and highlighting multicultural fraternities and sororities.

Student Life & Culture

- **Social Scene & Experiences**

- The dating scene at USC

- The transition from on-campus to off-campus living
- Comparison of underclassmen vs. upperclassmen experiences
- Why students from states like New Jersey choose to come to USC
- The importance of joining professional fraternities
- The effect of Greek life rush on student mental health
- The experience of living with a roommate for the first time
- Reflective editorials from seniors looking back on their time at USC

- **Student Life & Broader Culture**

- Supporting USC's music culture (student bands, a cappella groups, etc.)
- The obsession with true crime is concerning.
- Is Gen Z desensitized to violence and explicit content (e.g., *Saltburn*, *Dahmer* series)?
- "Chronically online" culture and viral trends: dependence on social media and its triggering effects on individuals with body image issues or mental health disorders.
- Commentary on award shows like the Golden Globes.
- Halloween topics:
 - * Cultural misappropriation in costumes
 - * The impact of fast fashion on Halloween costumes

Politics, Social Issues & Media

- **Elections & Civic Duty**

- Where do students get their news from?
- The importance of media literacy and voter education.
- The importance of voting (e.g., noting the SC registration deadline).
- Investigating voter apathy among students.
- How political organizations on campus are sometimes treated like solicitors.
- Coverage of the upcoming governor elections.
 - * *Angle*: Event coverage on SC political campaigns

- **Technology & Society**

- Data leaks and privacy issues on campus and beyond.
 - * *Angle*: How does this growing problem tie into the rise of AI?
- The use of AI tools in education.
 - * *Angle*: An opinion piece arguing that AI will actually make students smarter and that most current studies warning against it are heavily flawed.
- The frustrating experience of buying a car from a dealership.
 - * *Angle*: Explore modern alternatives like online purchasing through Amazon.
- The rebranding of Twitter to X.
 - * *Angle*: Congress is investigating the wrong social media platform (TikTok)

- **National & State Issues**

- Debate over age limits for members of Congress.
- The push for a minimum wage increase.

- Rent increases around the Columbia area.
- Gun policies in South Carolina.
- Weed legalization in South Carolina.

Prompts & Advice for Writers

• **Finding Stories**

- Focus on things that aren't in the direct spotlight.
- Pay attention to what's going on around you.
- When you see unfairness, think about that as a story.
- Pay attention to what bothers you personally.
- Write about things that are topical and current.
- Look for interesting personalities on campus to submit letters to the editor.
- Reach out to student leaders who want to get their own message out.
- Ask students: What do you go through in your daily life?
- Talk to strangers.

• **Political Angles**

- Ask students: Are you registered to vote?
- Look into voter apathy.
- What elections are coming up?
- Remember: The governor decides how much funding the university gets from the state.

NEW IDEAS added later:

Clemson vs usc which school is better

Gamedays should be held in the afternoons

Electric Scooters should be allowed on campus

Student housing crisis

Game day uber fiasco

Supporting small businesses in Columbia

Grubhub robots